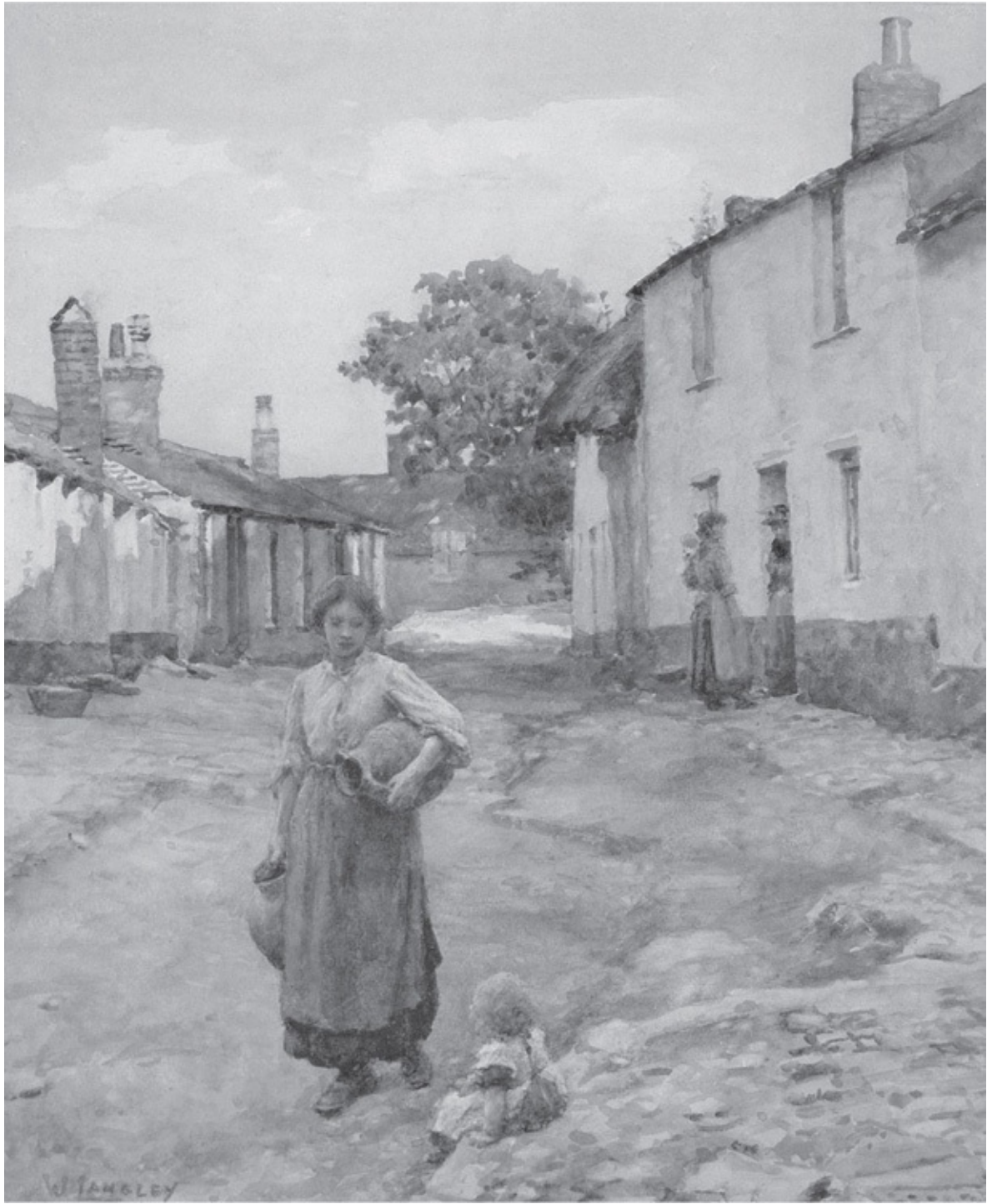


St Ives and the Newlyn School

The unique light, distinctive landscape and wild seas of Cornwall in southwest England have always been a magnet for artists. In the late 19th century, a group of painters settled in the fishing villages of Newlyn and St Ives, and began depicting local scenes of rural life, capturing the light, rolling land, rugged coast and dramatic sea. Led by Stanhope Forbes (1857–1947) and Frank Bramley (1857–1915), they became known as the Newlyn School.

St Ives attracted artists who were inspired by the shallow crescent of its bay, and the clear natural light. In 1920, Bernard Leach (1887–1979) and Shoji Hamada (1894–1978) set up a pottery, and during the 1930s, Ben Nicholson (1894–1982), Barbara Hepworth (1903–79) and Christopher Wood (1901–30) established an artists' colony. For a short time they were joined by the Russian Constructivist Naum Gabo. From c.1950, younger artists also took inspiration from the locality. They included Wilhelmina Barns-Graham (1912–2004), Terry Frost (1915–2003), Roger Hilton (1911–75), Patrick Heron (1920–99) and Peter Lanyon (1918–64).



Walter Langley, *A Newlyn Street*, c.1885